



A+ LAB SERIES V5

Lab 4: Windows Control Panel

Document Version: **2026-01-02**

Material in this Lab Aligns to the Following	
CompTIA A+ (220-1201) Exam Objectives	
CompTIA A+ (220-1202) Exam Objectives	1.3: Compare and contrast basic features of Microsoft Windows editions. 1.6: Given a scenario, configure Microsoft Windows settings. 2.1: Summarize various security measures and their purposes. 2.2: Given a scenario, configure and apply basic Microsoft Windows OS security settings. 3.4: Given a scenario, troubleshoot common personal computer (PC) security issues.

Contents

Introduction	3
Objective	3
Lab Topology	4
Lab Settings	5
1 Using Settings to Make Configurations	6
1.1 Determine the Current Updates installed with Windows 10	6
2 Configuring Windows 11 with Control Panel Applets	9
2.1 Power Optimization using Control Panel Applet with Windows 11	9
2.2 Internet Options with Control Panel Applet with Windows 11	14
3 Configuring Windows 10 with Control Panel Applets	25
3.1 Folder Options with Control Panel Applet with Windows 10	25
3.2 Action Control Panel Applet for Configuring User Account Control with Windows 10	30

Introduction

The Control Panel is the central location for managing individual components, known as applets, which contain settings and options to control various aspects of the operating system.

In Windows 10 and Windows 11, there has been a significant shift towards using a new tool called Settings. Settings is intended to become the primary tool for managing system configurations, gradually replacing the Control Panel, especially in Windows 10. This transition continues in Windows 11, further emphasizing the Settings app as the primary interface for a more streamlined, user-friendly experience.

Objective

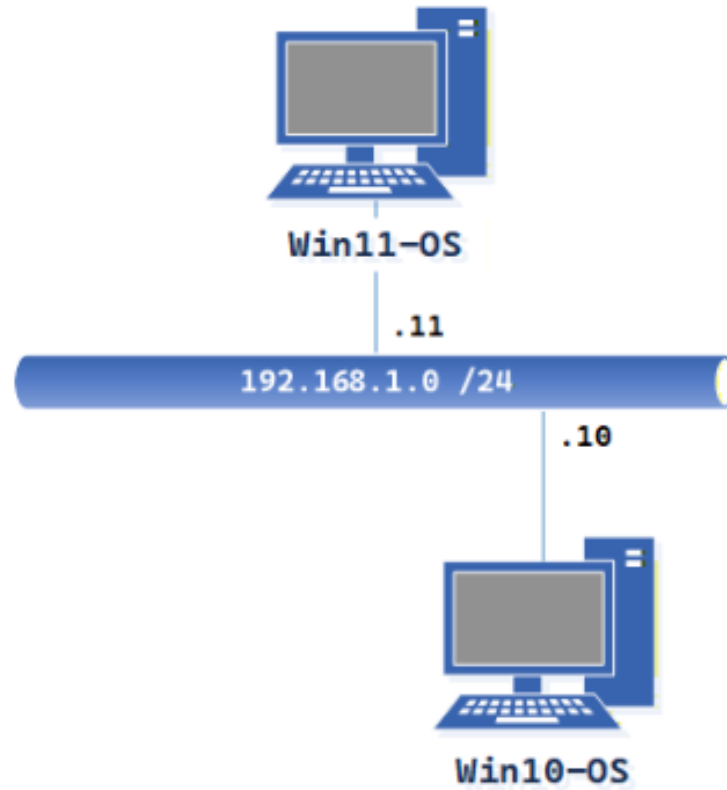
Settings and the *Windows Control Panel* applets can be used to change Windows settings, depending on the version. Both allow you to control settings that affect how *Windows* looks and performs. They can be used to customize *Windows* for the user.

In most versions of *Windows*, the default view of the Control Panel is the Category view. Control Panel applets can be viewed by Category, which groups them logically, or in the large- or small-icons views, which list them individually. It is a personal choice how to view them, but for these labs, the view selected will be *Small icons*.

In this lab, you will be performing the following tasks:

- Determine the current Windows updates using Settings.
- Change display settings.
- Configure Power Options through the Control Panel Applet.
- Configure Internet Options through the Control Panel Applet.
- Configure Personalization Options through the Control Panel Applet.
- Configure Folder Options through the Control Panel Applet.
- Configure Action Center and UAC settings.

Lab Topology



Lab Settings

The information in the table below will be needed to complete the lab. The task sections below provide details on the use of this information.

Virtual Machine	IP Address	Account (if needed)	Password (if needed)
Win10-OS	192.168.1.10 / 24	sysadmin	NDGLabpass123!
Win11-OS	192.168.1.11 / 24	sysadmin	NDGLabpass123!

1 Using Settings to Make Configurations

Settings is a newer replacement of the *Windows Control Panel*. It performs most of the same functions, but in some instances, it navigates the user to the *Control Panel* to complete certain configurations.

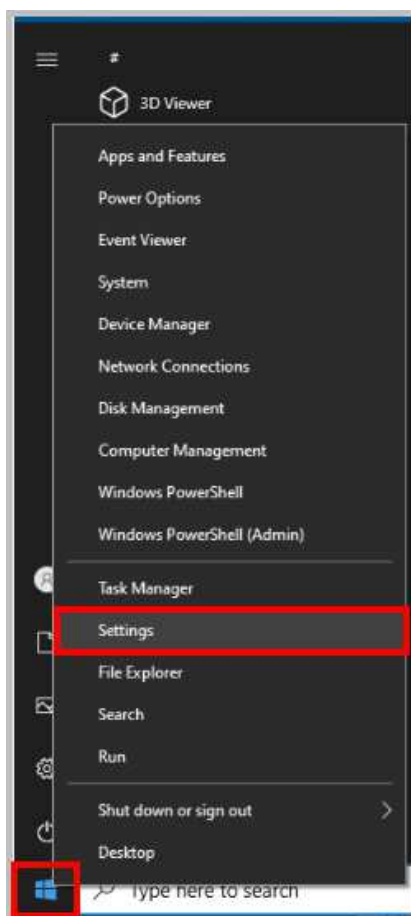
1.1 Determine the Current Updates installed with Windows 10

1. Open a console connection to the **Win10-OS** system.

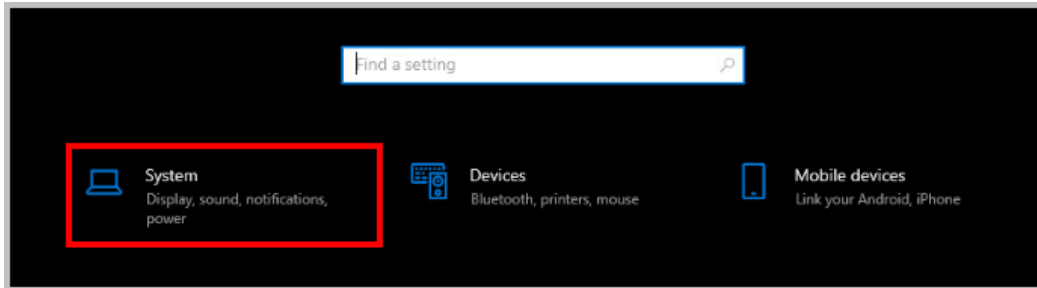


To launch the console for a lab device, you can click on the respective tab in the navigation bar at the top or navigate to the *Topology* section and click the lab device's corresponding image.

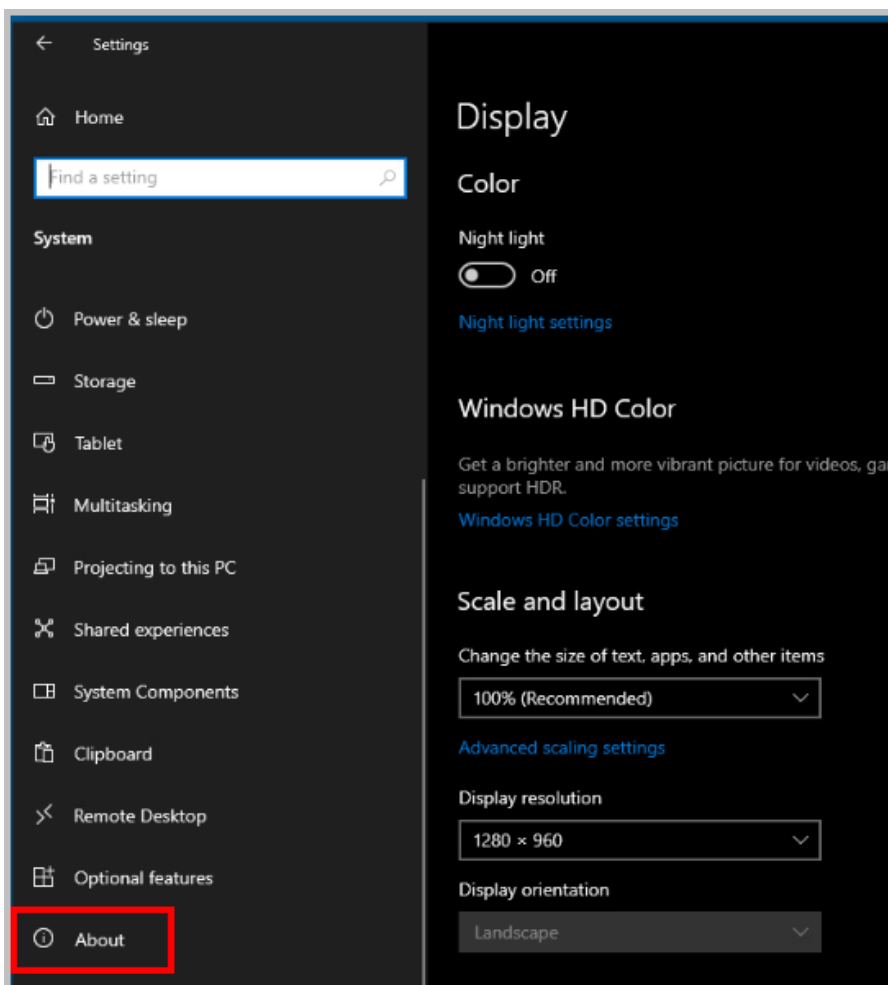
2. Right-click the **Start** menu and click on **Settings**.



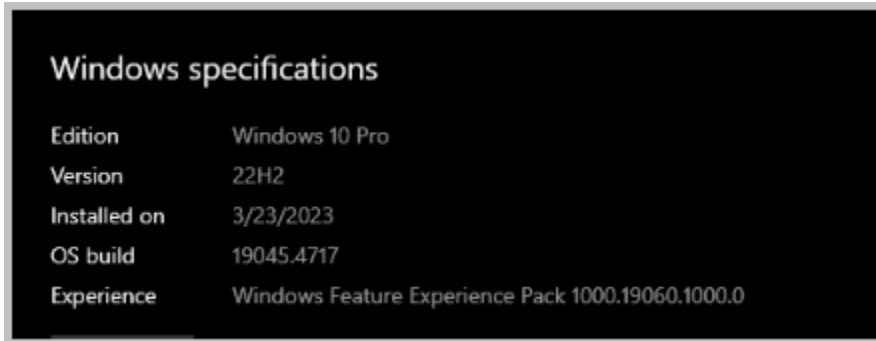
- Click on **System** from the *Windows Settings* screen.



- In the left pane, scroll down the list under System, and click on **About**, which is located at the bottom, so you will have to scroll down.



5. In the right panel, scroll to the **Windows specifications** heading and identify the *Version* and *OS Build*. This will display the latest major update installed.



Challenge Task:

As a challenge, try to recreate this task in a different version of *Windows* OS that is made available in this lab environment. This will help show similarities and differences between the versions.

6. Leave the Settings Window open and move on to the next lab.

2 Configuring Windows 11 with Control Panel Applets

The Windows 11 Control Panel applet is a small app within the Control Panel that lets you manage specific settings and features on your computer.

Each applet is designed to handle tasks such as managing network connections, setting up printers, or customizing appearance options.

Common Control Panel Applets in Windows 11:

- *System*: This applet provides information about your computer's hardware and software, including processor speed, memory, and operating system version.
- *Devices*: Used to manage devices connected to your computer, including printers, scanners, and other peripherals.
- *Network and Internet*: Allows you to configure network settings, create connections, and manage internet access.
- *Hardware and Sound*: Provides options for managing sound devices, adjusting volume, and configuring hardware components.
- *User Accounts*: Used to create, manage, and delete user accounts on your computer.
- *Appearance and Personalization*: Allows you to customize the appearance of your desktop, including themes, wallpapers, and color schemes.
- *Clock and Region*: Used to set the date, time, and region settings for your computer.
- *Ease of Access*: Provides options for making your computer more accessible to users with disabilities.



Note:

The specific applets available and their names may vary slightly depending on the edition and version of Windows 11 you are using

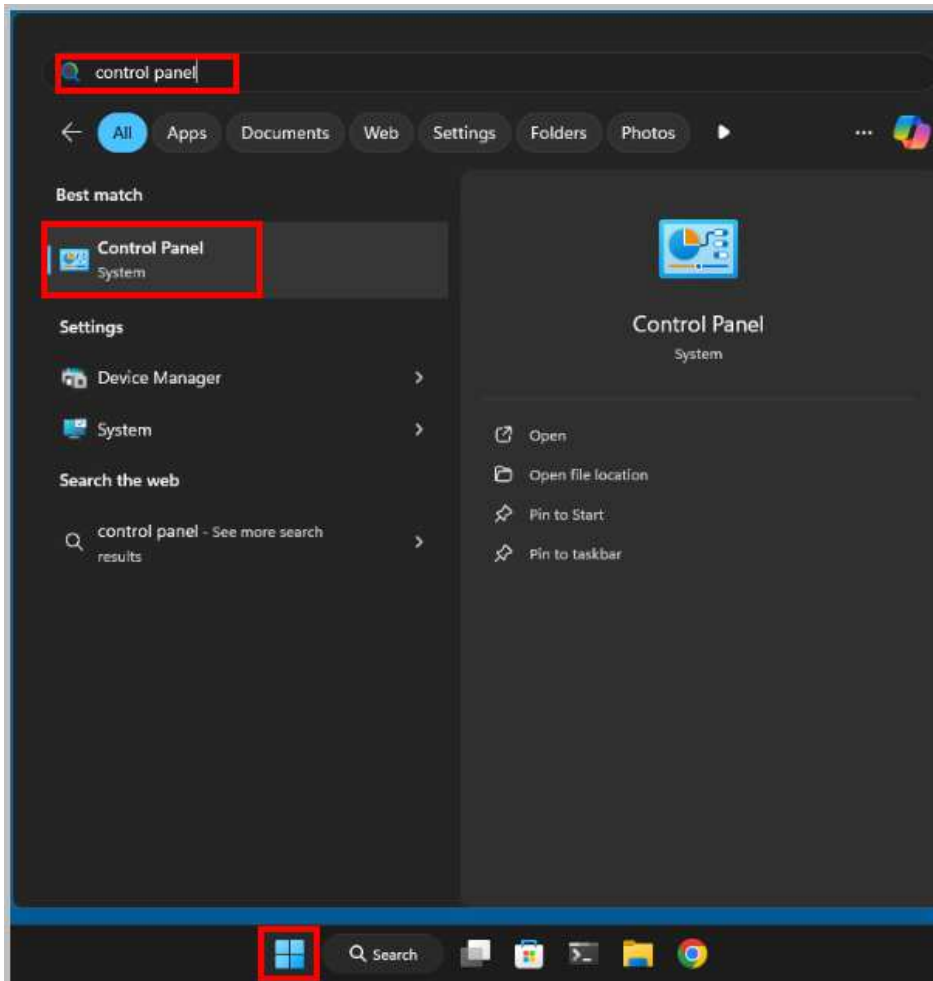
2.1 Power Optimization using Control Panel Applet with Windows 11

The *Control Panel* applet, *Power Options*, contains settings regarding how your computer uses power.

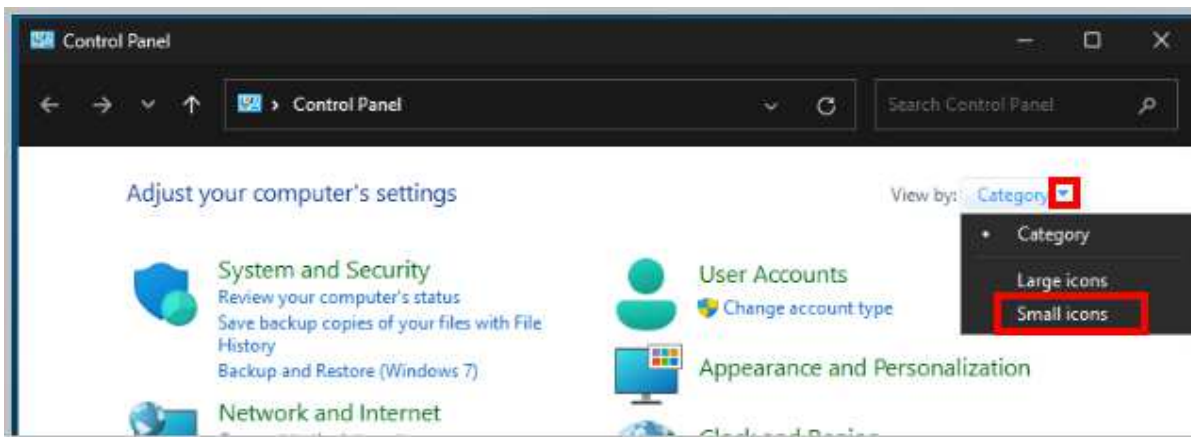
1. Open a console connection to the **Win11-OS** system.



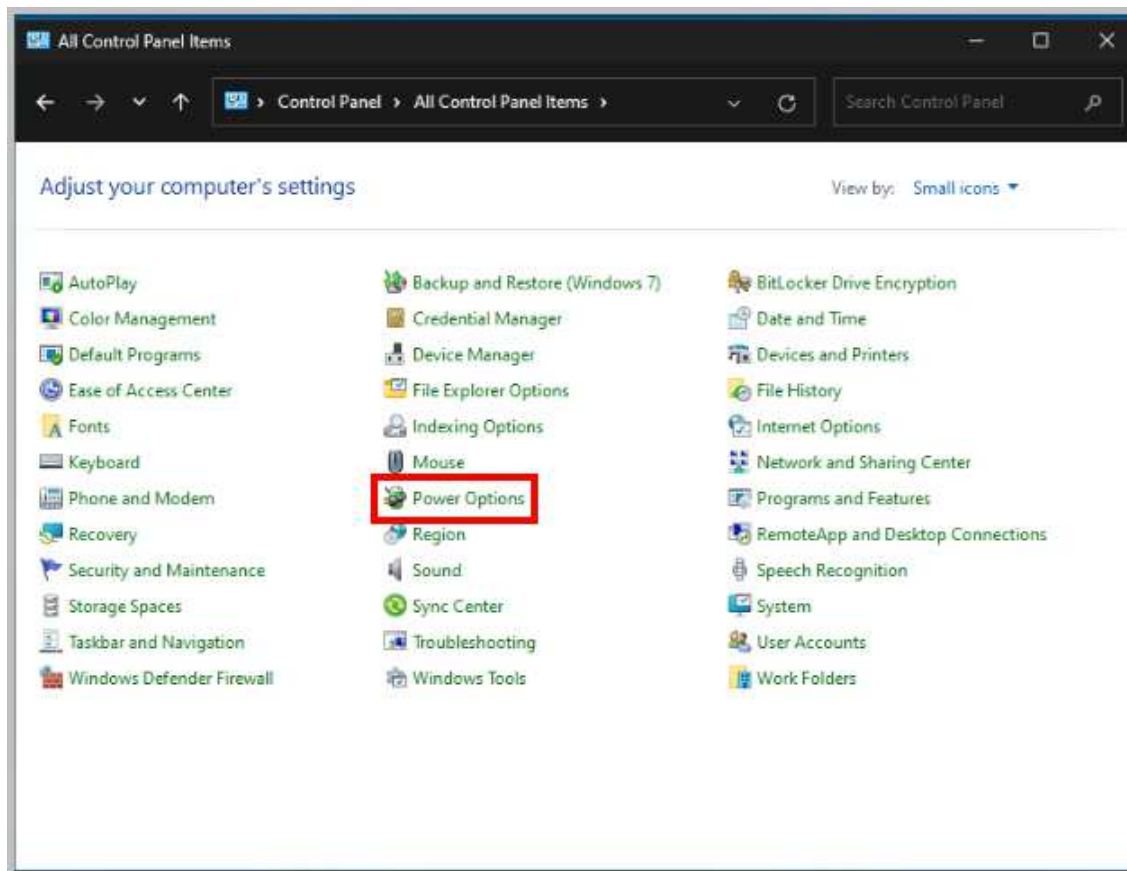
- Click the **Start Button** in the Taskbar. In the Search Box, type **Control Panel**. Click the **Control Panel Application**.



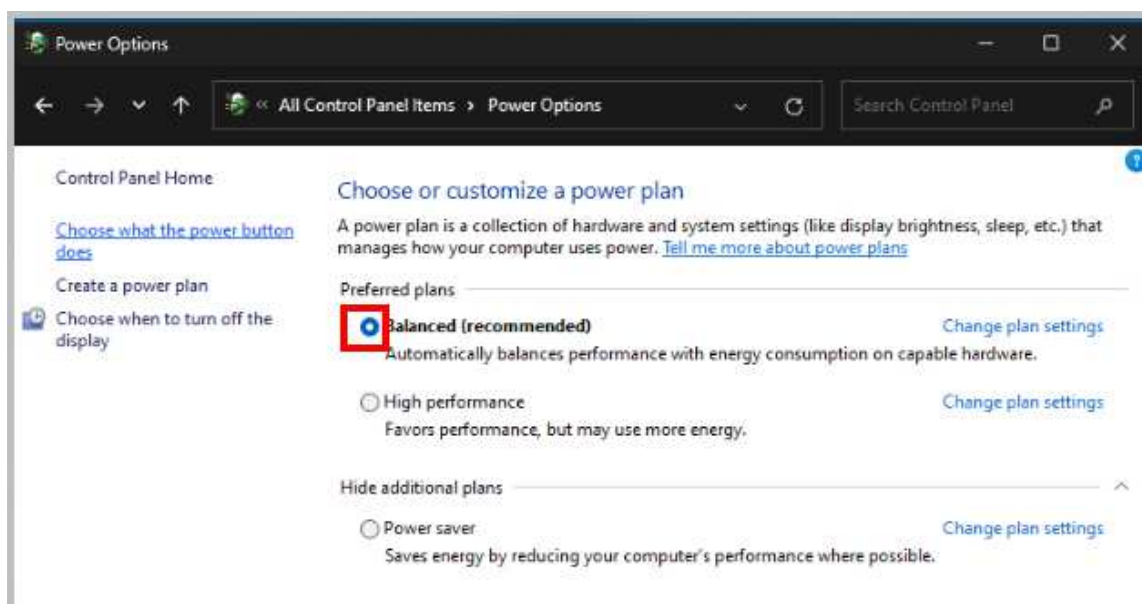
- Select the drop-down arrow next to Category and change the *View* to **Small icons**.



4. Click on **Power Options**.



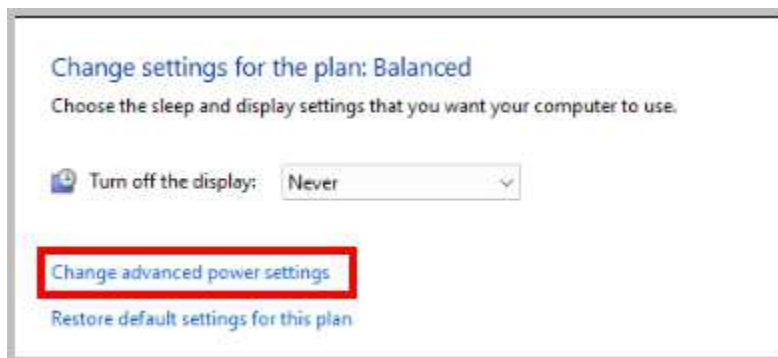
5. Click the radio button next to **Balanced (recommended)** to change to the *Balanced* power plan.



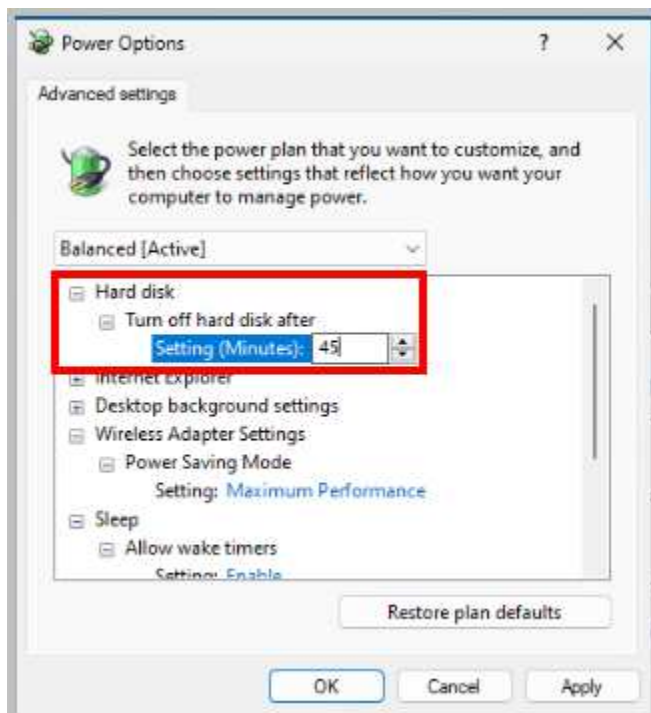
6. Click on **Change plan settings** to the right of *Balanced (recommended)*.



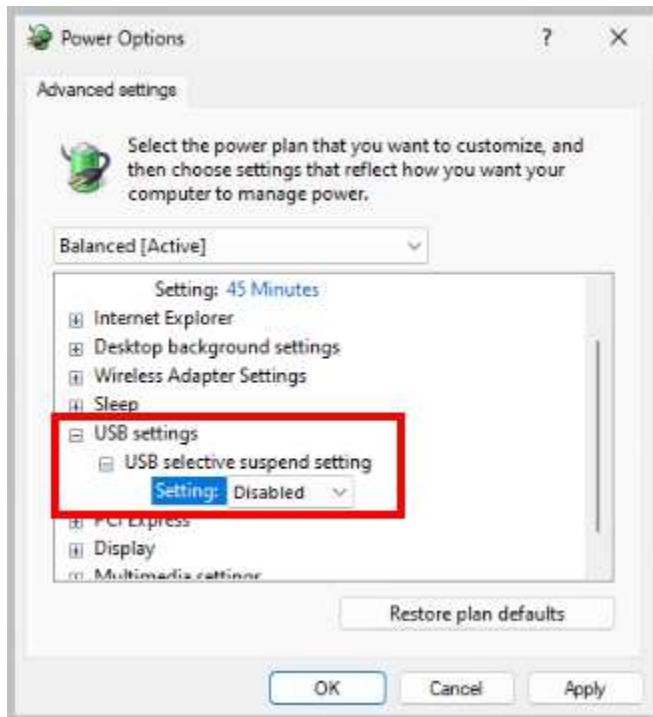
7. Click on **Change advanced power settings**.



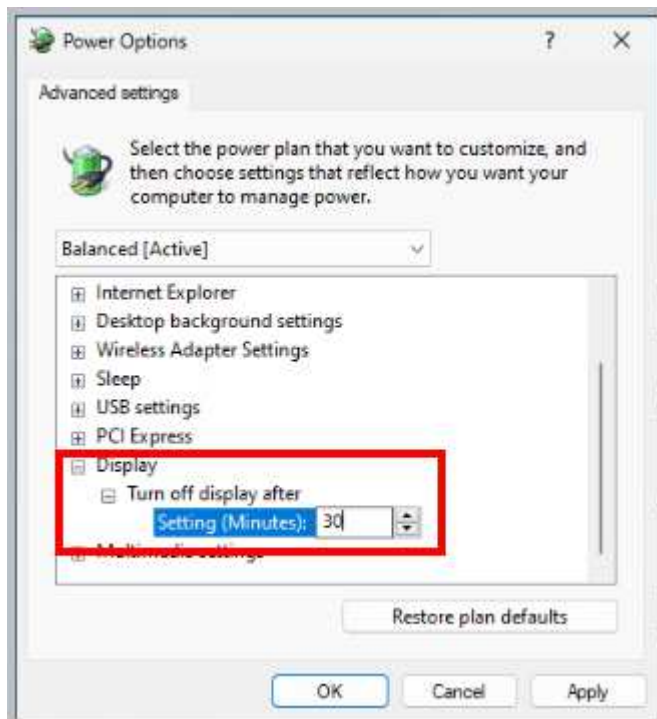
8. Scroll through all the options and familiarize yourself with the available options. Expand **Hard disk** by clicking on the + symbol, then continue to expand **Turn off hard disk after**. Change the setting for **Turn off hard disk after** to **45 Minutes**.



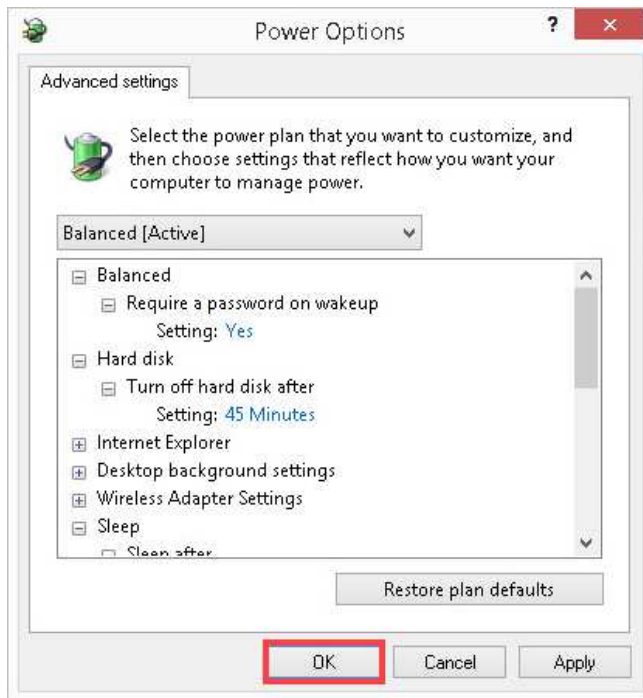
9. Expand **USB settings > USB selective suspend setting** and change the **USB selective suspend setting** to **Disabled**.



10. Expand **Display > Turn off display after**, and change **Turn off display after** to **30 Minutes**.



11. Click **OK** to save the changes.



12. Close the **Edit Plan Settings** window.



Challenge Task:

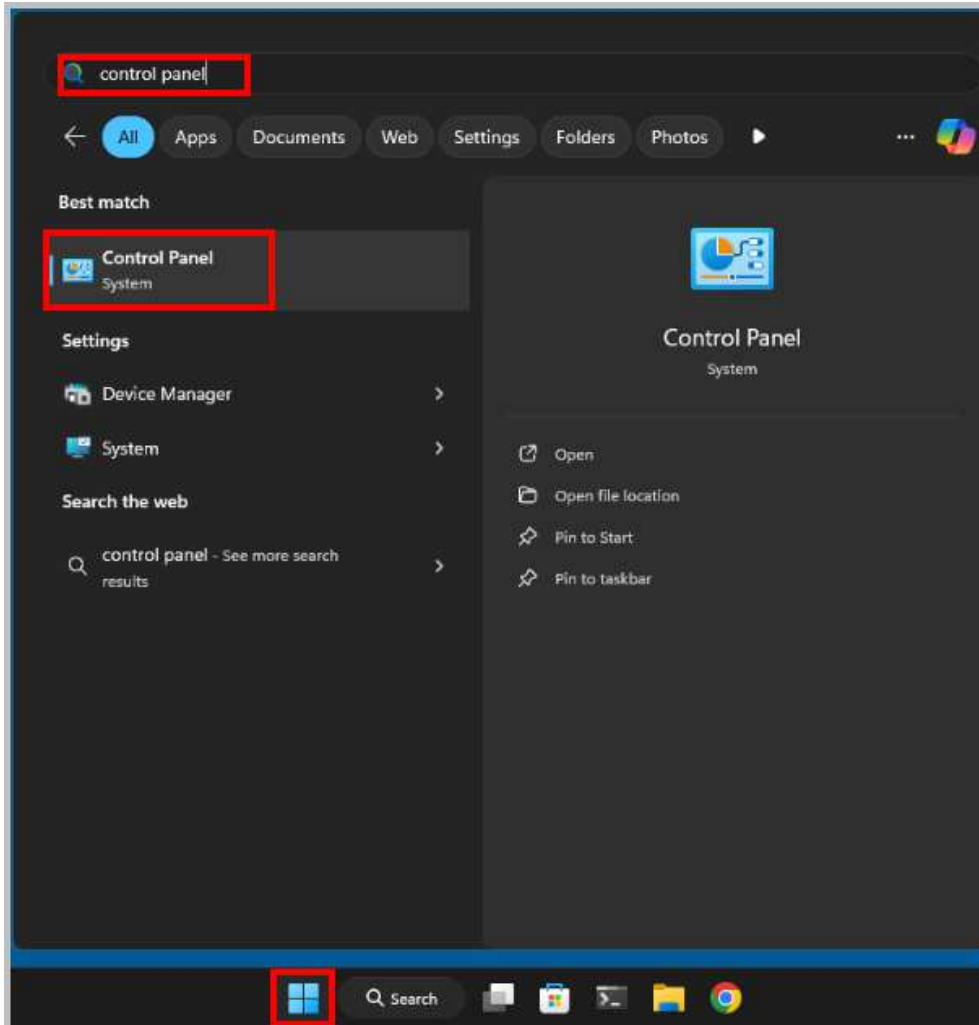
As a challenge, try to recreate this task in a different version of *Windows OS* that is made available in this lab environment. This will help show similarities and differences between the versions.

13. Leave the *Win11-OS* window open to continue with the next task.

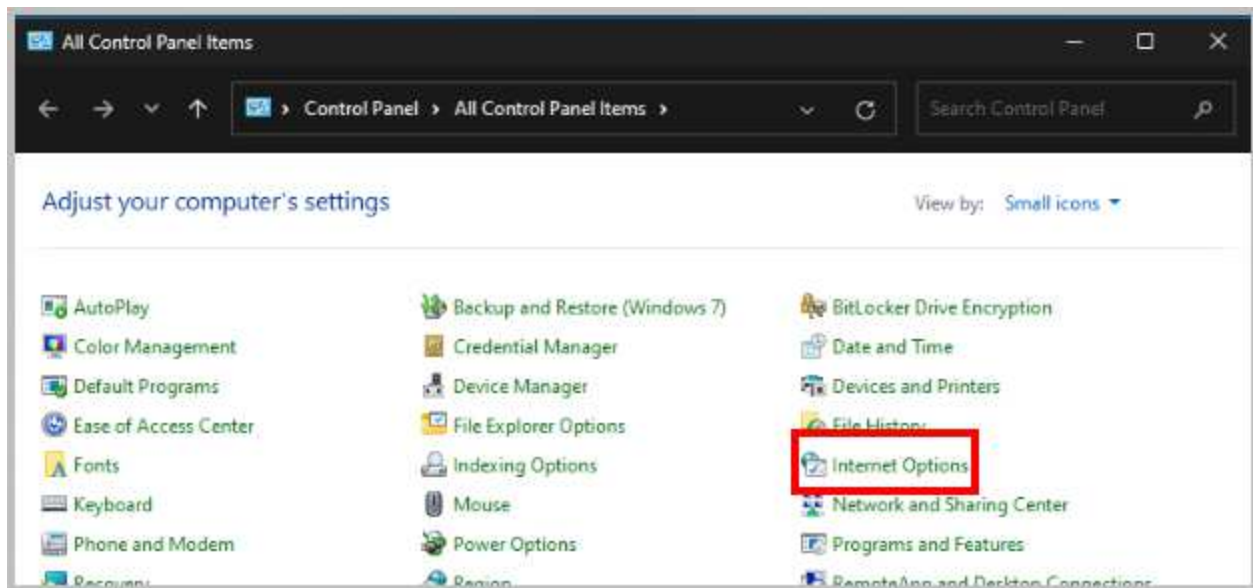
2.2 Internet Options with Control Panel Applet with Windows 11

Users can change how a system manages Internet connections and Internet Explorer browser settings. The *Control Panel* applet, *Internet Options*, opens the *Internet Properties* window for the current version of *Internet Explorer* installed on your computer.

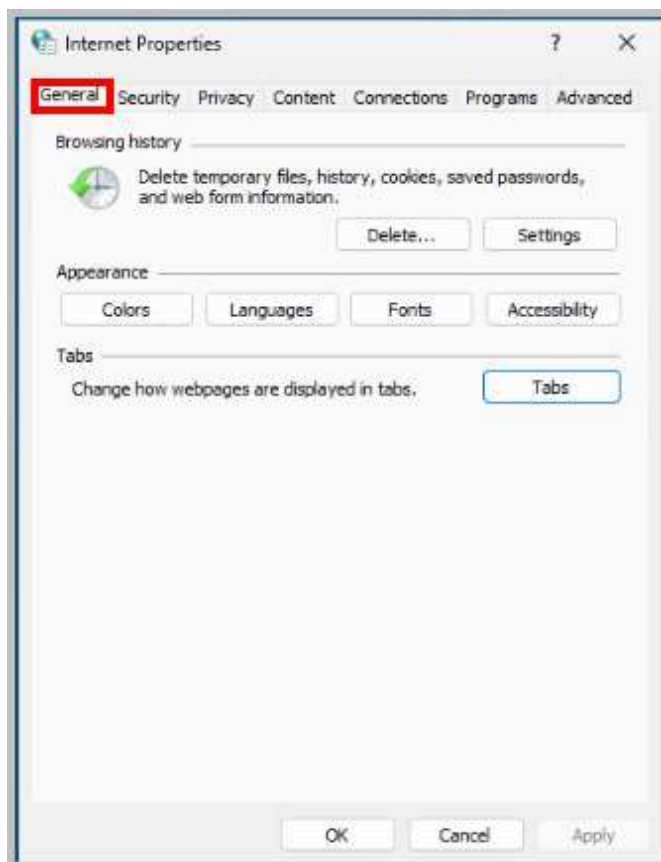
1. Click the **Start Button** in the Taskbar. In the Search Box, type **Control Panel**. Click the **Control Panel Application**.



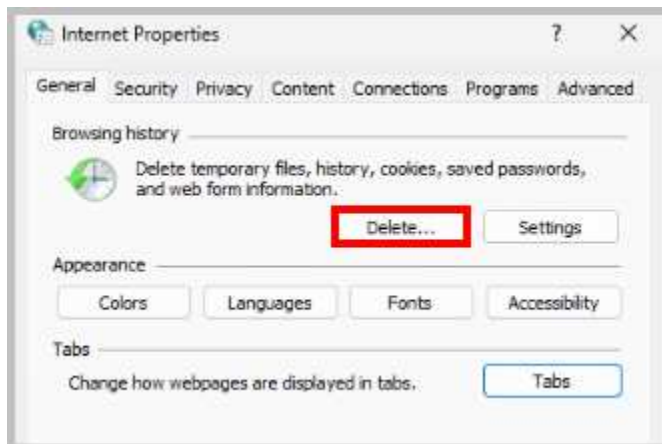
2. Notice how the Control Panel view stayed as *Small icons*. Click on the **Internet Options** applet.



3. Notice that the *Internet Properties* window appears. Many changes can be made to the *General* tab, including deleting and adjusting Settings for Browsing History, making Appearance Changes, and adjusting preferences for tabs of webpages



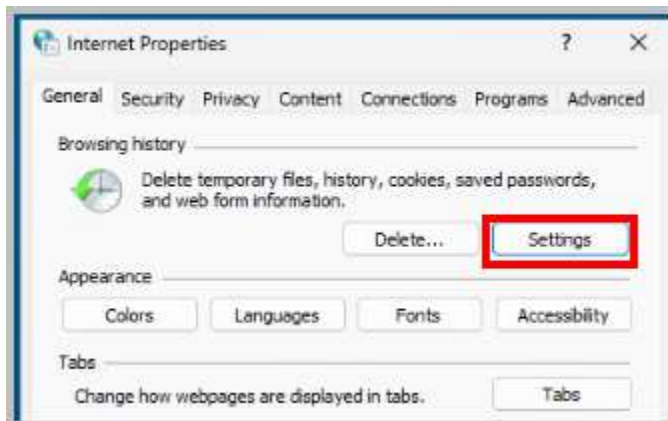
- Click the **Delete** button under the *Browsing history* section.



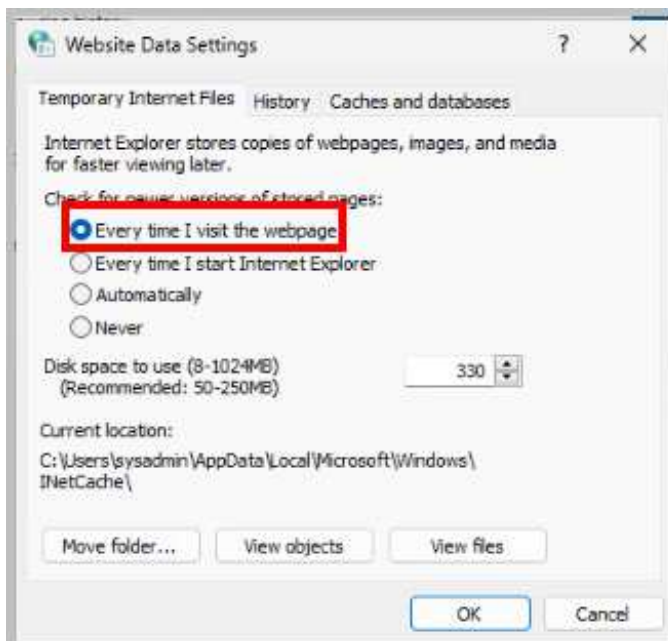
- Internet Browsers* will store several types of data on the system when you surf the Internet. Periodically deleting this data will help keep your hard drive clean and remove unnecessary files. Ensure that the **Preserve Favorites website data**, **Temporary Internet files**, **Cookies**, and **History** are **checked**. Click **Delete**.



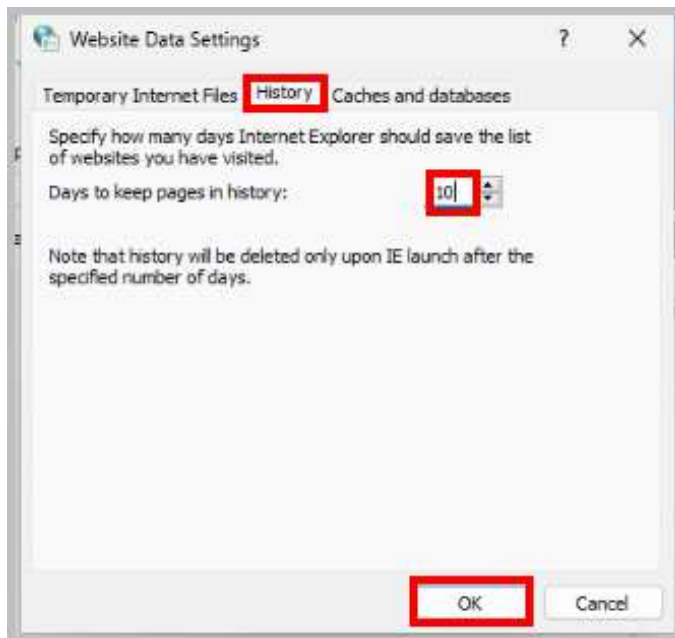
6. Back on the *Internet Properties* window, click the **Settings** button under the *Browsing history* section.



7. In the *Website Data Settings* window, select the radio button next to **Every time I visit the webpage** to ensure that you view the newest version from the original server for that website.



8. Click on the **History** tab. Reduce the number of **Days to keep pages in history** to **10**. Click **OK**.

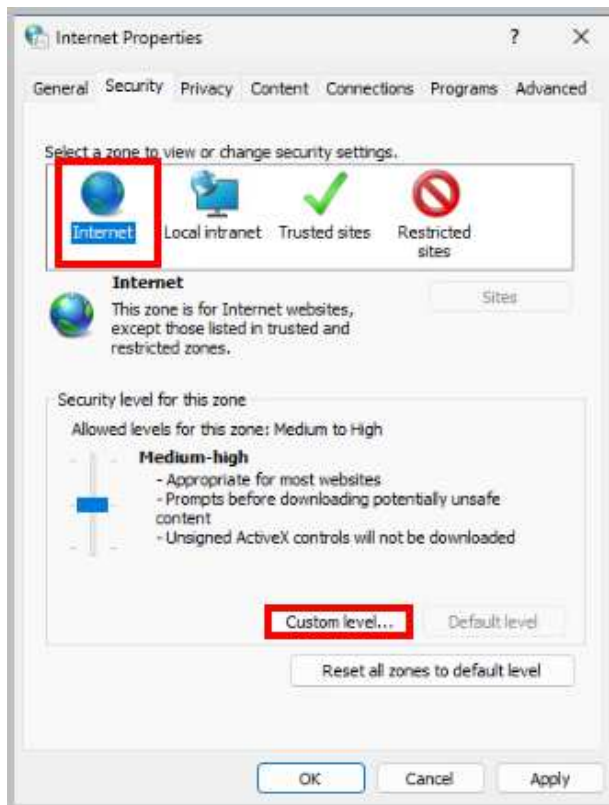


9. Back on the *Internet Properties* window, click on the **Security** tab.

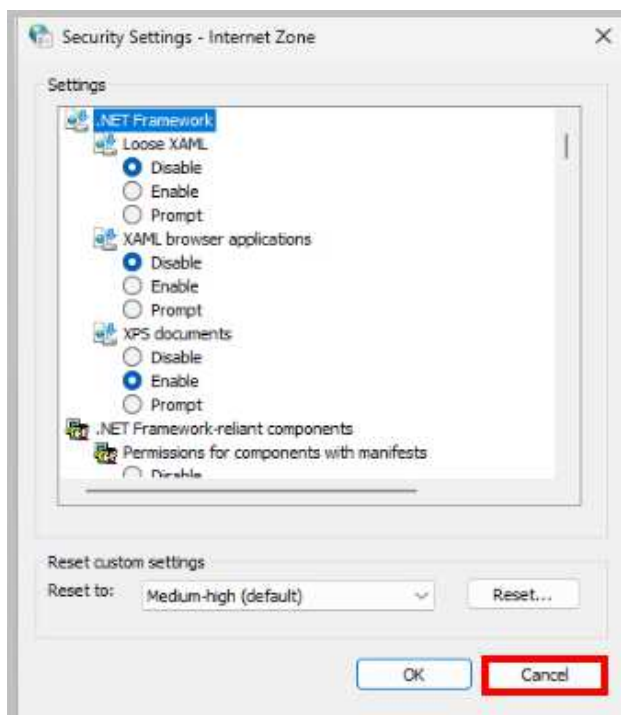


On the *Security* tab, the Internet is categorized into four different zones (*Internet*, *Local intranet*, *Trusted sites*, and *Restricted sites*). You can select a security level for each zone. *Local*, *Trusted*, and *Restricted* zones include the *Sites* button, to allow individual site inclusion and exclusion. The *Sites* button is not available if Internet is the selected zone.

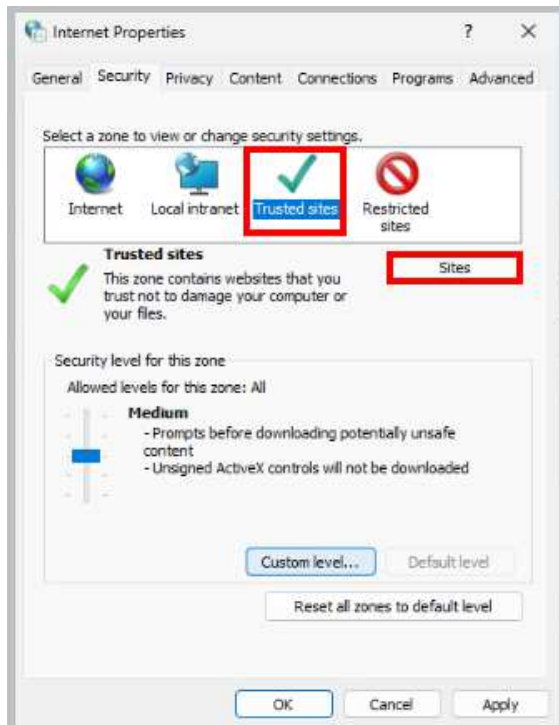
10. Click on the **Internet** zone and then click the **Custom level** button.



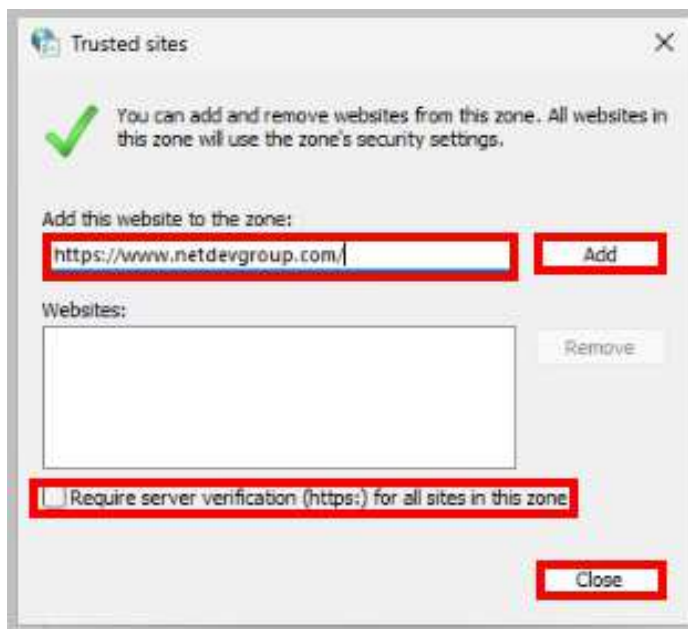
11. Review the numerous settings that can be managed here. Disabling many of the options in these settings and then adding *Trusted Sites* with *Custom Levels* enabled is a best practice. Click **Cancel** to exit from the window.



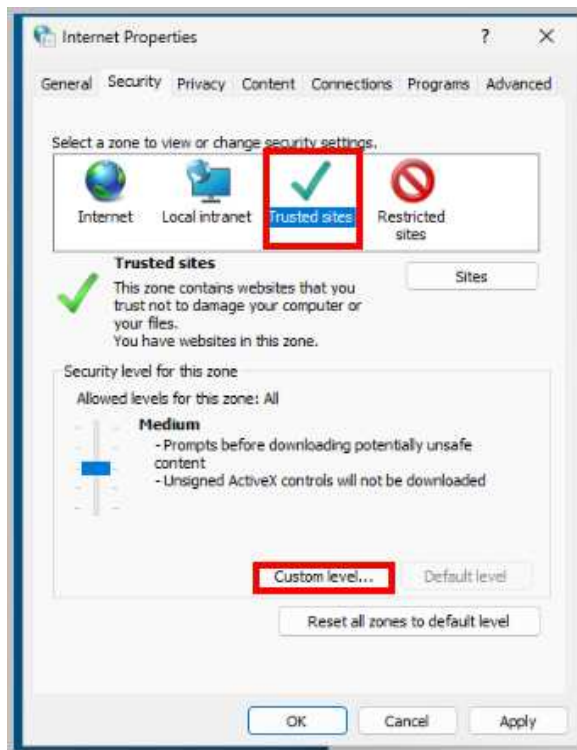
12. Back on the *Internet Properties* window, click on **Trusted sites** followed by clicking on the **Sites** button.



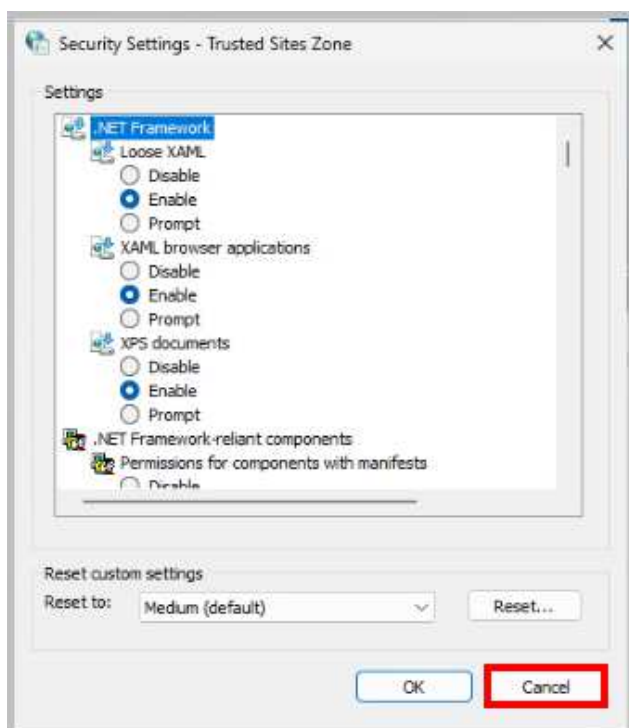
13. In the *Trusted sites* window, uncheck **Requires server verification**. Type `https://www.netdevgroup.com/` in the *Add this website to the zone* text field, followed by clicking the **Add** button. Click **Close** once finished.



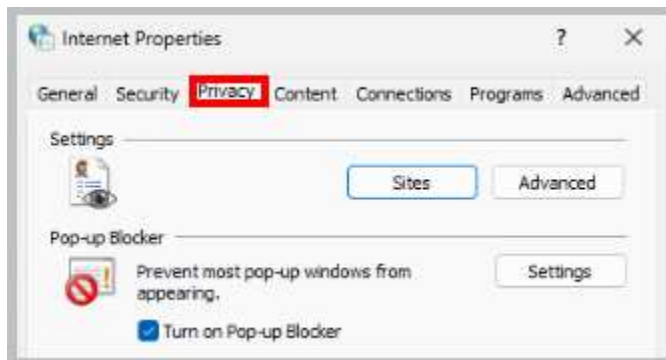
14. Ensure that **Trusted sites** is highlighted and click the **Custom Level** button.



15. Notice that most settings are enabled. Trusted sites can be added to your list to allow things like popups and *JavaScript* to run. *JavaScript* or spyware could potentially damage your PC or compromise your security, but you could add them because the sites are known to you and not expected to be malicious. Click **Cancel** to close the *Security Settings - Trusted Sites Zone* window.

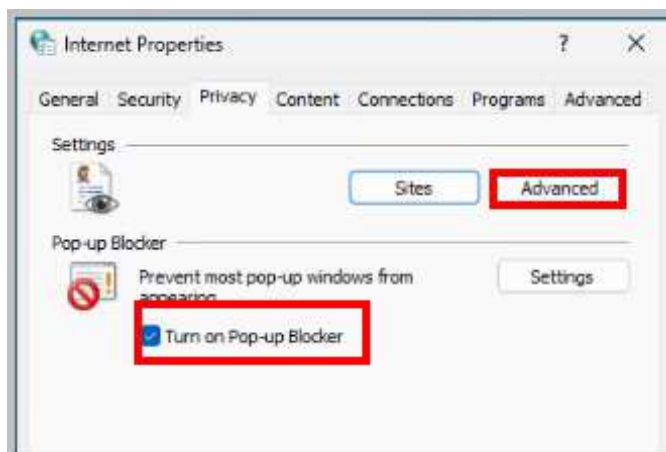


16. Back on the *Internet Properties* window, click on the **Privacy** tab.

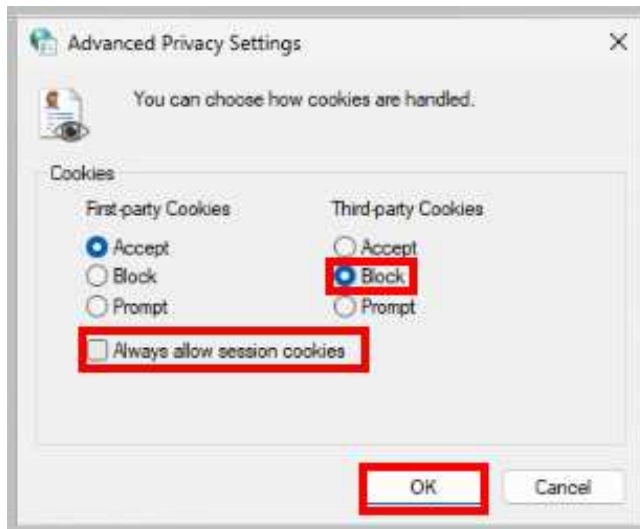


The *Privacy* tab allows you to choose your cookie settings and whether to allow popup windows. A *cookie* is a small text file that a website places on a PC to store information such as a user's surfing habits or store personal information about you that a website gathers when you visit it. Popups are usually just annoying ads, but a few can be malicious, launching harmful scripts in the background, or trying to get spyware onto a PC.

17. Ensure that there is a check in the checkbox for **Turn on Pop-up Blocker**. Click the **Advanced** button.



18. Uncheck **Always Allow session cookies**, then proceed by selecting the radio button next to **Block**, underneath *Third-party Cookies*. Click **OK** to save the configuration.



19. Back on the *Internet Properties* window, click **OK**.



Challenge Task:

As a challenge, try to recreate this task in a different version of *Windows OS* that is made available in this lab environment. This will help show similarities and differences between the versions.

20. Leave the *Win11-OS* window open to continue with the next task.

3. To configure Internet Options, go to:
 - a. Settings > User Accounts > Internet Options
 - b. Control Panel > Internet Options
 - c. Start > Internet Options
 - d. File Explorer > Internet Options

3 Configuring Windows 10 with Control Panel Applets

3.1 Folder Options with Control Panel Applet with Windows 10

In this exercise, you will learn how to reveal hidden files and folders in *File Explorer*, as well as how to enforce known file type extensions to become visible.

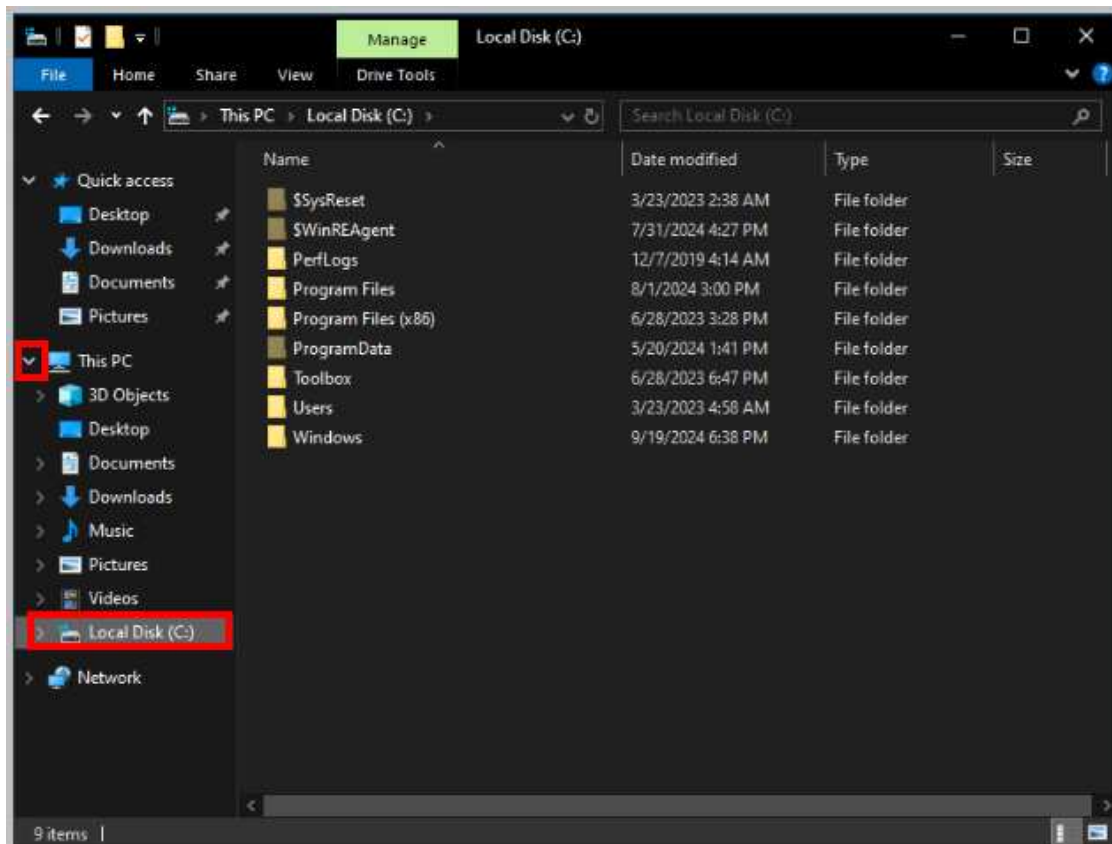
1. Switch back to the **Win10-OS** system.



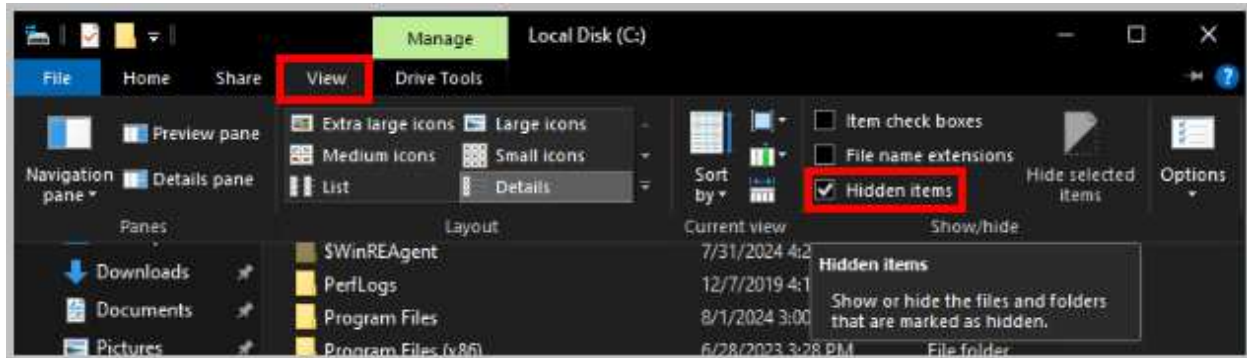
2. Click on the **File Explorer** icon located in the taskbar.



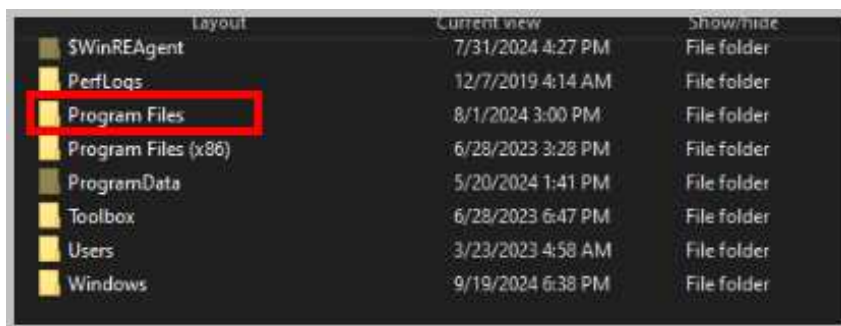
3. Select the **drop-down arrow** to expand This PC. Select **Local Disk (C:)**. Review the available folders.



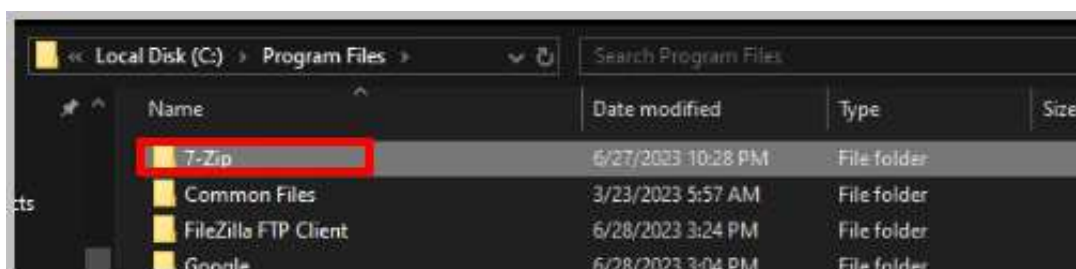
- Click on the **View** menu item located near the top of the window and verify the checkbox next to **Hidden items** is already checked.



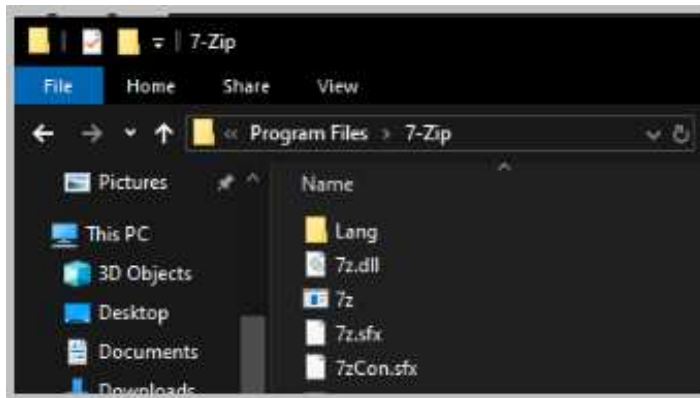
- By default, the *ProgramData* folder is normally hidden. Notice that the *ProgramData* folder has a different color folder, which visually shows it is a hidden file that is now available. Double-click on the **Program Files** folder.



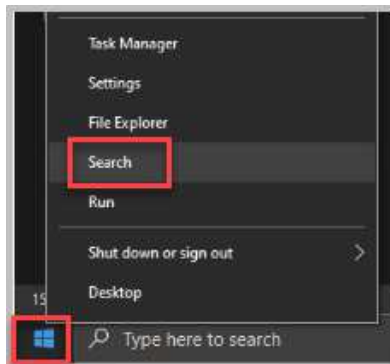
- Double-click on the **7-Zip** folder.



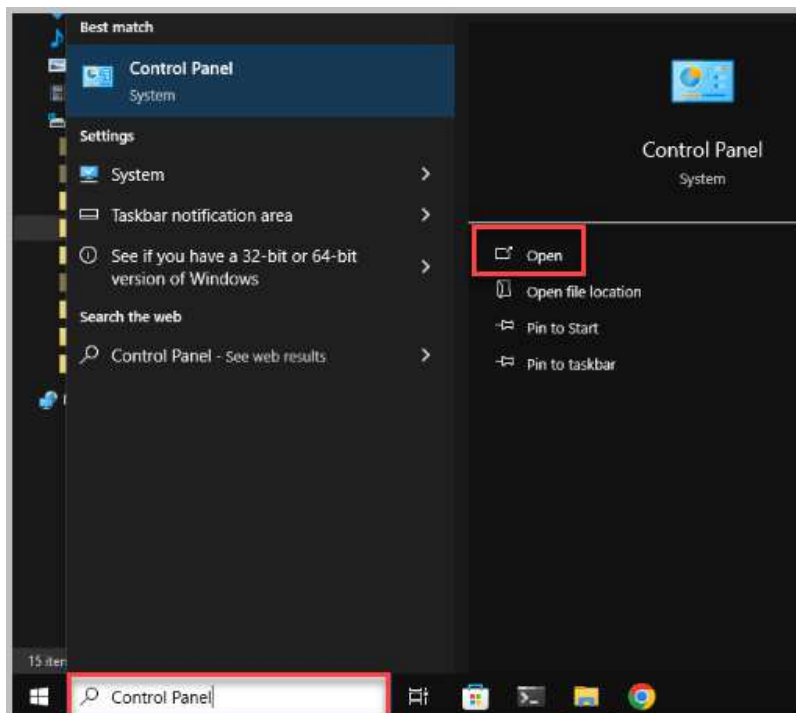
7. Notice the filenames within the folder do not have file extensions listed.



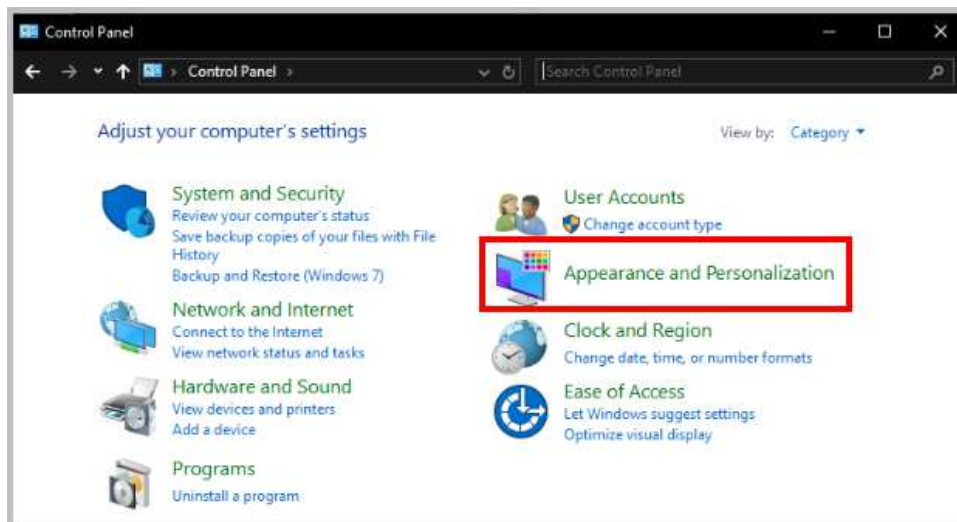
8. Right-click the **Start** button and select **Search**



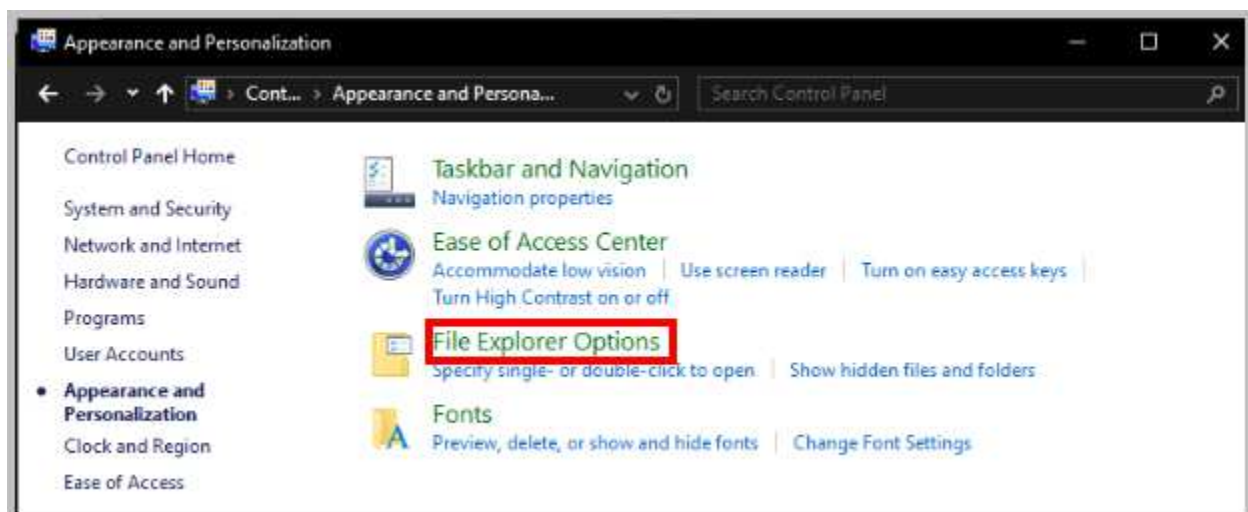
9. Search for **Control Panel** and select to **Open**.



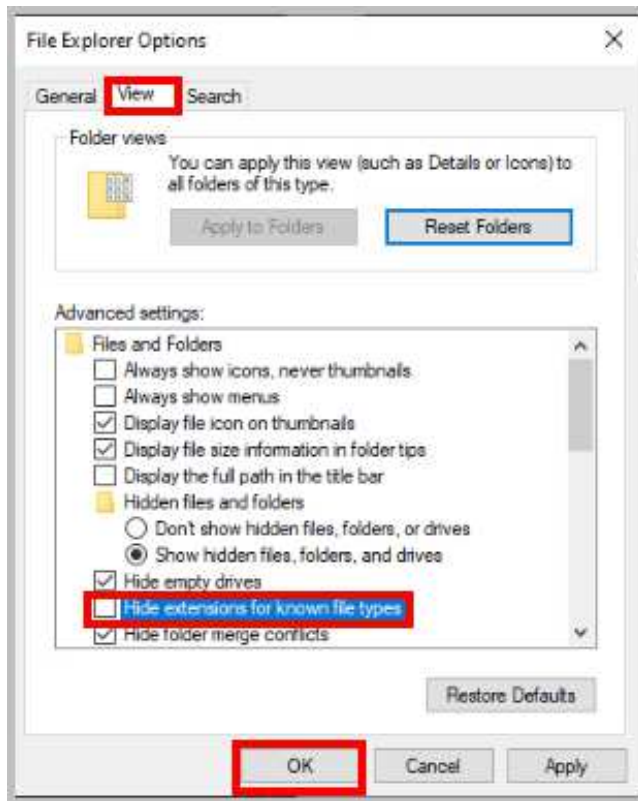
10. In the *Control Panel* window, click on **Appearance and Personalization**.



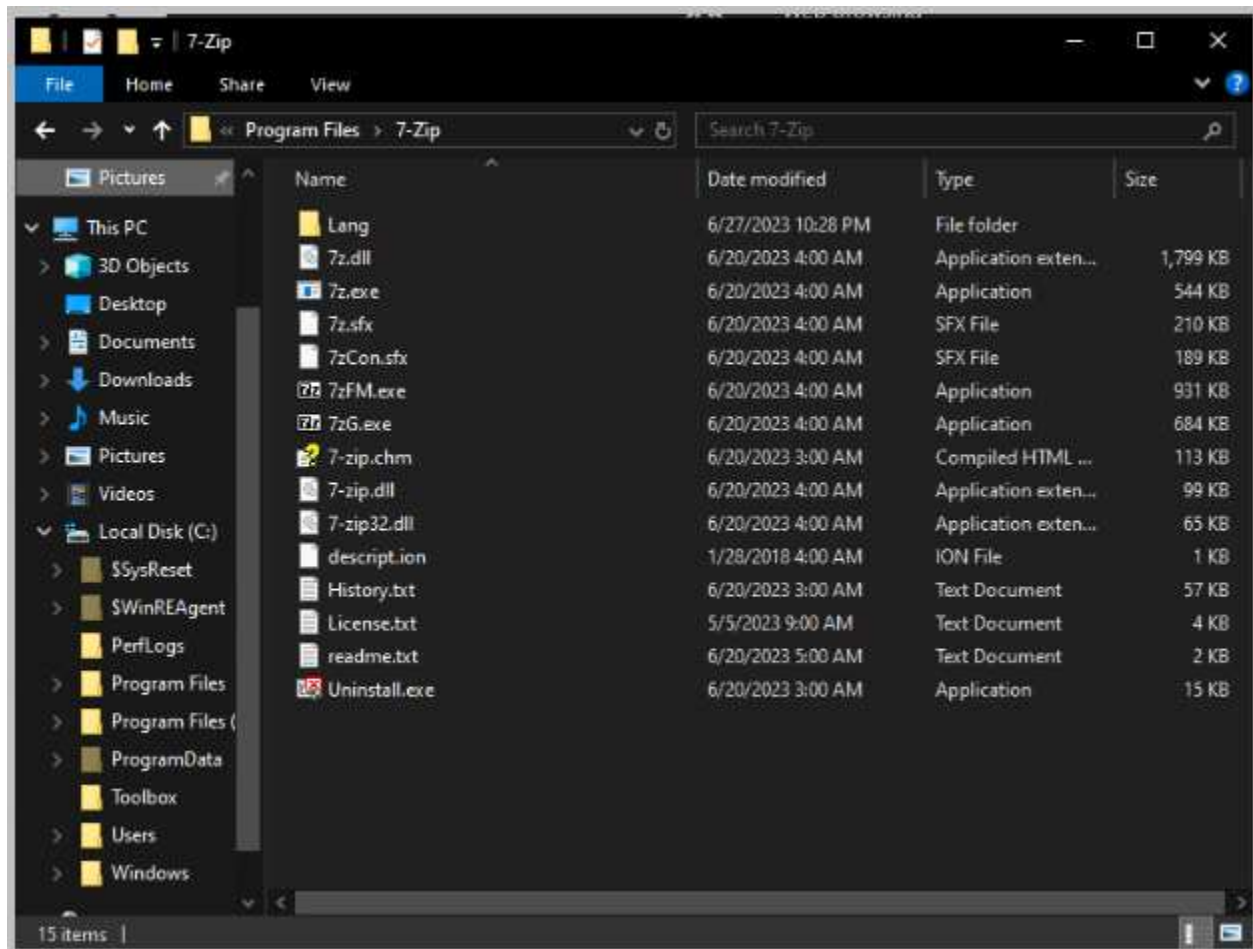
11. Select **File Explorer Options**.



12. In the *File Explorer Options* window, click on the **View** tab and **uncheck** the checkbox next to **Hide extensions for known file types**. Click **OK** to save changes.



13. Change focus to the **File Explorer** window with the **7-Zip** folder opened. Notice that the filenames now display their known extensions, such as **.exe** and **.txt**.



Challenge Task:

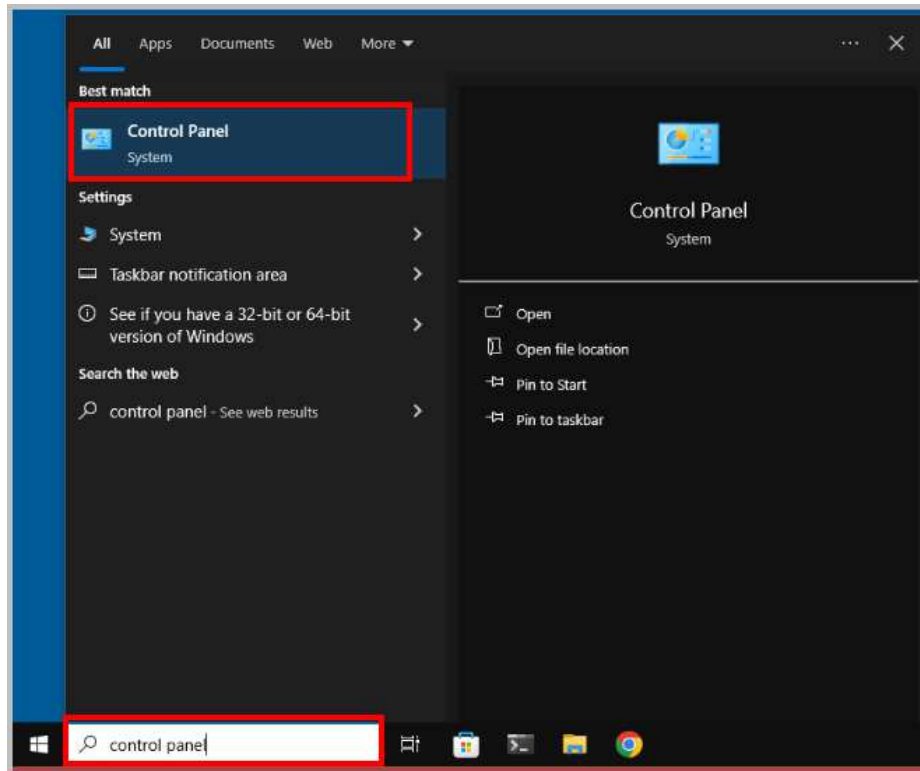
As a challenge, try to recreate this task in a different version of *Windows* OS that is made available in this lab environment. This will help show similarities and differences between the versions.

14. Close the File Explorer, Appearance and Personalization, and Settings Windows.
15. Leave the *Win10-OS* window open to continue with the next task.

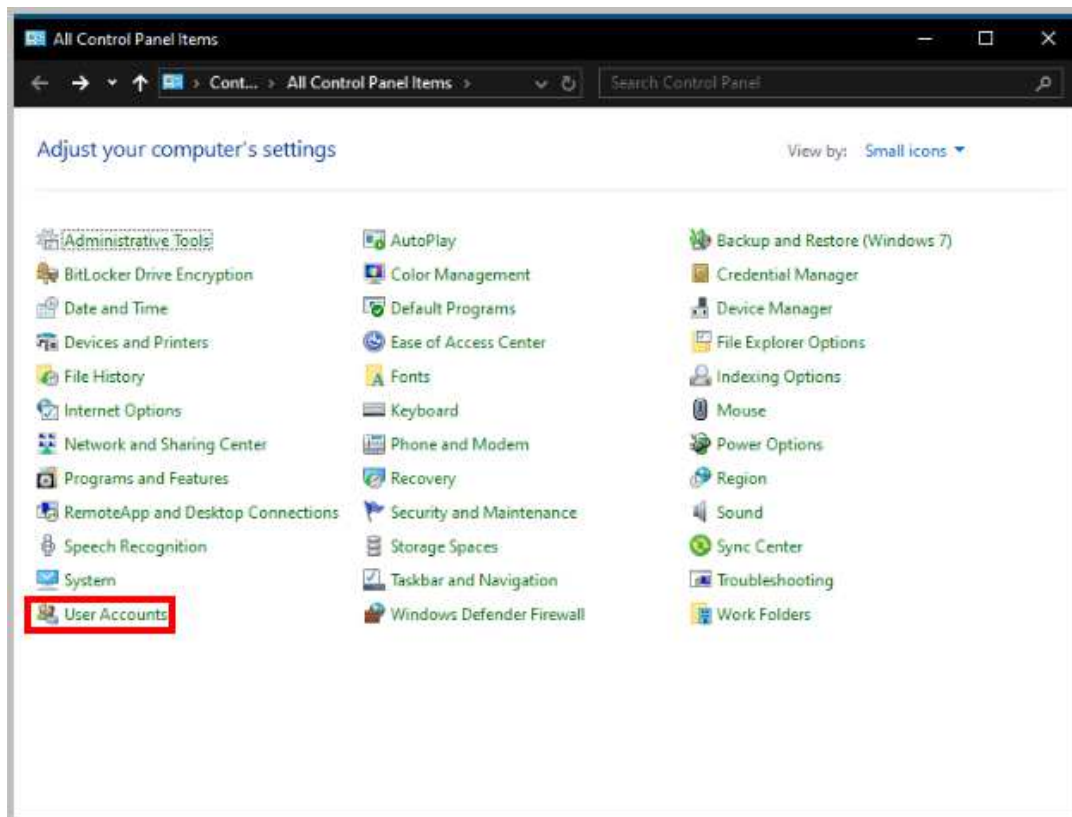
3.2 Action Control Panel Applet for Configuring User Account Control with Windows 10

The *Action Center Control Panel* applet is a centralized place to see security and maintenance settings and alerts. *User Account Control (UAC)* helps defend your PC against intrusion and malicious software. Whenever a program wants to make a significant change to your computer, *UAC* lets you know and asks for permission.

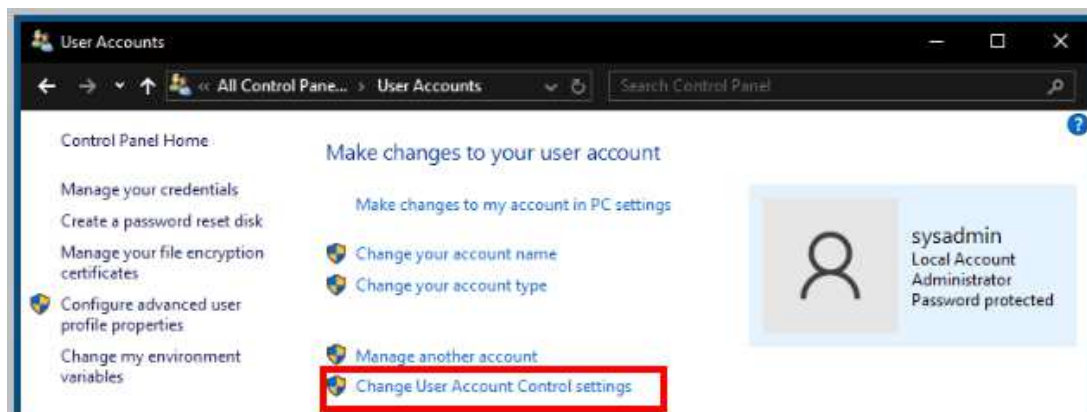
1. While on the Win10-OS machine, in the search box next to the start button, search for **Control Panel**. Select the **Control Panel Application**.



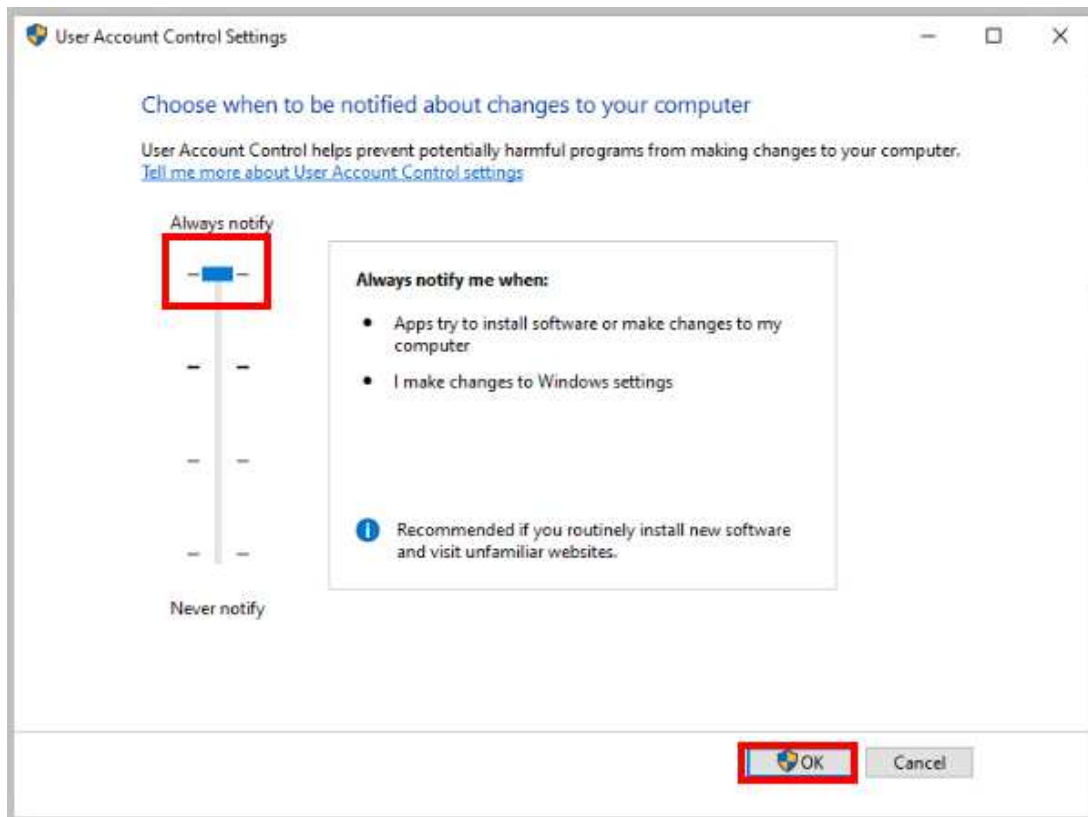
2. Click on **User Accounts** from the *Control Panel* window.



3. Under Make changes to your user account, click **Change User Account Control Settings**.



4. Change the slider all the way up to indicate **Always notify** (highest setting). Click **OK**.



5. Notice the *User Account Control* warning appears, click **Yes** to continue.



Challenge Task:

As a challenge, try to recreate this task in a different version of *Windows OS* that is made available in this lab environment. This will help show similarities and differences between the versions.

6. The lab is now complete; you may end the reservation.